

large measure. He calls himself, indeed, by the official title borne by former kings, "Preserver of Esagila and Ezida," but his concerns were evidently elsewhere. In the ancient city of Sippar he razed to the foundations the remains of the temple of the Sun (Shamash), which had been restored but forty-five years before by Nebuchadrezzar. There he found the very lowest foundation stone, on which his savants read the name of Naram-Sin, who lived, as their records showed, thirty-two hundred years before.¹ Upon that exact spot the new foundations were laid and above them rose a new temple far more splendid than the former. For its roof no less than five thousand cedar beams were brought from the far-distant northland, while yet others were required for its massive doors.

At about the same time he reconstructed the temple of E-ulbar, the shrine of the goddess Ishtar-Anunit. There he did not find the earliest foundation, but contented himself with one laid only eight hundred years before his time.

While all these works were in progress another people, fresh and vigorous, untainted by the decay which civilization has often brought, were preparing to undo this splendor and possess the wealth and power which Nabonidus had inherited or amassed.

The beginnings of new powers in the world's history are usually obscure, and to this rule the rise of the great people who were to engulf Babylonia is no exception. But certain lines in the great movement are sufficiently clear to be traced with some certainty. The fall of Nineveh was brought about by the alliance between the Medes and the Babylonians, but it was

¹ V R., 62, b, 57-60. Compare *Keilinschriftl. Bibl.*, iii, 2, p. 105; compare Rogers *History of Babylonia and Assyria*, i, p. 318f.